



Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities

D2.TTO.CL4.07

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual

Project Base

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: DEVELOP INTERPRETIVE CONTENT FOR ECO-TOURISM ACTIVITIES		NOMINAL HOURS: 70
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTO.CL4.07		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to develop interpretive content for a range of eco-tourism activities.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Research information 1.1 Describe the <i>interpretive approach</i> to guiding and activities 1.2 Identify <i>sources of information</i> for eco-tourism knowledge 1.3 Determine <i>customer interests and potential themes</i> for possible <i>interpretive activities</i> 1.4 Use <i>research techniques</i> to obtain information 1.5 <i>Classify and store information</i> 1.6 <i>Verify information</i> that has been gathered 1.7 Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points Element 2: Prepare an eco-tourism activity 2.1 <i>Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points</i> for potential eco-tourism activities		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to organisations that are involved in developing interpretive content for eco-tourism activities within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Interpretive approach</i> commonly uses face-to-face methods and is frequently supported by interpretive media and aids. The interpretive approach should include: • Engaging the participants • Providing a verbal commentary to explain and translate the characteristics, significance and features of the tour • Attributing local and cultural meaning to sights and activities • Facilitating learning, understanding and awareness • Contextualising the tour within a local framework and flavour

2.2 <i>Acquire physical resources</i> to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points 2.3 <i>Generate scripted commentaries</i> to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points 2.4 <i>Trial developed eco-tourism activities</i> for identified concepts, themes and focal points 2.5 <i>Revise developed eco-tourism activities</i> on the basis of feedback 2.6 <i>Promote prepared eco-tourism activities</i>	• Generating respect and appreciation for the local customs, history and people • Provoking curiosity, thought and encouraging personal reflection • Bringing the tour to life by providing opportunities for learning and participation • Building a relationship between the tour groups and the environment/focus of the tour. <i>Sources of information</i> may include: • The internet • Local communities • Relevant peak preservation and conservation bodies • Authorities, including published reports • Text books and literature.
Element 3: Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities 3.1 <i>Take action to receive information</i> from relevant bodies 3.2 <i>File and share new information</i> 3.3 <i>Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities</i> 3.4 <i>Create new activities</i> 3.5 <i>Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading</i>	<i>Customer interests and potential themes</i> will include: • Flora, including types, history, concentrations, growth patterns, threats, seasonal influences, preservation and conservation issues • History and heritage of the general area with attention to special items or areas of interest • The general natural environment • The built environment, including its impact on the eco-system • Individual species, including their history, current context and predicted future, foods, predatory inclinations, habitats, mating habits, life cycle and threats • Specific geographic locations and landmarks • Feedback from customers and co-workers suggesting topics for activities • Initiatives recommended by local authorities and local communities • Topics of general community interest.

	<i>Interpretive activities</i> may include: • Guided walks • Guided site activities, including interactive and static displays • Touring activities • Commentaries • Problem solving activities • Concept testing activities • Spotting and observation activities • Sensory experiential activities • Any activity that facilitates engagement with the subject that is the focus of the activity. <i>Use research techniques</i> should include formal and informal research techniques and may include: • Personal observation • Interviews with relevant stakeholders • Undertaking primary data research activities • Gathering secondary research data from existing sources • Monitoring media articles. <i>Classify and store information</i> should include: • Allocating research data into identifiable categories • Establishing and maintaining paper-based and electronic storage and retrieval systems • Preserving actual samples.
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	<i>Verify information</i> should relate to: • Confirming accuracy, currency and relevancy of information • Validating contested pieces of information with authorities and relevant others • Obtaining credible evidence to support the integrity of information collected • Checking with local communities and stakeholders to confirm or deny research material. <i>Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points</i> may include: • Prioritising options that have been identified • Evaluating practicality of implementing available options, including impact, cost, sensitivity, timing, safety and sustainability issues • Planning physical and ancillary requirements to deliver selected options • Setting specific objectives for each eco-tourism activity. <i>Acquire physical resources</i> may include: • Purchasing ready-made materials • Designing and building identified requirements • Seeking to borrow materials from stakeholders • Preparing printed material, including handouts, exercises, guides and fact sheets • Obtaining necessary permissions and authorisations to conduct activities in areas that are sensitive, restricted or of significance to local indigenous communities • Ensuring resources used comply with principles of environmental sensitivity, including considering recycling, re-use and minimal impact • Matching the resources to the identified objective for each of the identified eco-tourism activities.
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	<i>Generate scripted commentaries</i> may include: • Ensuring currency and accuracy, including a total ban on fabricating facts • Ensuring comprehensive and relevant information • Including necessary safety and security information relevant to the activity, time of day, conditions and other applicable issues • Ordering the information in logical sequence • Preparing sufficient and appropriate depth and breadth of information • Identifying delivery style • Matching words, phrases and terminology to the identified needs of customers • Explaining unfamiliar terms, abbreviations and acronyms • Including an interpretive orientation to the script • Checking grammar • Ensuring that language used does not give offence, including unintended offence in relation to gender, culture, race, age or personal characteristics • Matching the length of the script to the duration of the activity • Providing an appropriate mix of statistical and qualitative information • Ensuring the commentary explains and translates the characteristics, significance and features of the activity. <i>Trial developed eco-tourism activities</i> may include: • Conducting the eco-tourism activities as planned, including all planned activities and all scripted commentaries • Establishing monitoring and feedback for the trial • Including participants and observers for the trial
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	• Ensuring the trial reflects expected actual tour conditions for the activity, to the greatest extent possible • Recording the trial for later analysis or review. <i>Revise developed eco-tourism activities</i> must relate to evidence gathered during the trial and may include: • Changing the nature, scope, objective, timing or location of the activity • Altering the commentary • Changing the physical resources that supported the trial, including acquisition of new resources, providing alternative resources, or deleting the use of existing resources • Deciding not to proceed with an activity that has demonstrated significant negative or potentially dangerous or harmful impacts. <i>Promote prepared eco-tourism activities</i> may include: • Including the eco-tourism activity in new or existing advertisements, packages and itineraries • Erecting signage to support the activity • Notifying co-workers in relation to the activity. <i>Take action to receive information</i> may include: • Joining professional associations • Registering on-line with relevant sources • Maintaining a connection with relevant stakeholders and communities • Monitoring the media. <i>Share new information</i> may include: • Sharing information with colleagues • Sharing information with customers.
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Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities may include:

- Amending activities to suit new information, including static and interactive activities
- Updating printed materials provided to customers, including handouts and static signage at displays
- Changing the commentaries to include new information.

Assessment Guide

The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:

- Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to the operation of eco-tourism activities to ensure minimal impact and the need to conduct all such operations in consultation with appropriate communities
- Principles of minimal impact tourism activities and operation
- Knowledge of host country legislation, standards, regulations and codes of practice in relation to eco-tourism
- Ability to use research techniques
- Knowledge of key concepts of ecology which must include specific knowledge relating to the ecology of the environment where the eco-tourism activities are to be conducted; this knowledge may include biotic and physical factors, populations, biodiversity, abundance, food webs, life cycles, succession, zoning, nutrition, water, energy, interaction of species with the environment, impact of humans and natural events, characteristics and commonalities, as appropriate
- Knowledge of the interrelationships that exist between nominated parts of the eco-system
- Knowledge of ecological terminology
- Principles of interpretive guiding and activities
- Ability to write scripted commentaries, posters and general handout material
- Ability to plan and produce physical resources, materials, props and other physical requirements to support eco-tourism activities.

	Linkages To Other Units • Develop and update tourism industry knowledge • Follow safety and security procedures • Work as a tour guide • Conduct interpretive activities in the field • Demonstrate/observe respect for indigenous cultures • Research and share information on indigenous cultures • Develop and monitor culturally appropriate tourism activity • Plan, develop and evaluate interpretive activities • Prepare and present tour commentaries • Develop/monitor ecologically sustainable tourism operations. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of host enterprise policies and procedures in regard to the operation of eco-tourism activities to ensure minimal impact and the need to conduct all such operations in consultation with appropriate communities • Knowledge of host country legislation, standards, regulations and codes of practice in relation to eco-tourism • Demonstrated ability to apply principles of interpretive guiding and interpretive activities • Demonstrated ability to develop minimal impact tourism activities • Demonstrated ability to research a nominated eco-topic and present sufficient and valid information that could be used to develop an eco-tourism activity on a nominated focal point/objective
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- Demonstrated ability to prepare an eco-tourism activity, including commentary and all necessary supporting resources on a nominated theme appropriate for designated types of tour group members
- Demonstrated ability to update eco-tourism information and identify how that information and feedback received from colleagues and customers on a nominated eco-tourism activity can be integrated into a new or revised eco-tourism activity.

Context of Assessment

This unit may be assessed on or off the job:

- Assessment should include practical demonstration either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge
- Assessment must relate to the individual's work area or area of responsibility.

Resource Implications

- Training and assessment must include the use of real environments, real information, real materials and real eco-tourism settings; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment.

Assessment Methods

The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:

- Observation of practical candidate performance
- Portfolio of eco-tourism activities such as research material, handouts and other props, samples and similar that form the basis and that have been developed
- Feedback from people who have participated in the trial of an eco-tourism activity to gauge their level of satisfaction and engagement
- Role plays
- Oral and written questions
- Third party reports completed by a supervisor
- Project and assignment work.

	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Gather information as the basis for eco-tourism activities
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Prepare activities to communicate understanding to tour group members
	Planning and organising activities	2	Establish a system to classify and store information
	Working with others and in teams	2	Liaise with co-workers and customers to identify suitable activities
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	-	
	Solving problems	1	Validate contested information
	Using technology	1	Use the internet for research

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities D2.TTO.CL4.07
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. What are the common purposes of conducting eco-tourism tours or activities?	☐	☐
2. Why is it important to have knowledge of the eco-tourism industry?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Why is it important to identify customer needs when identifying suitable eco-tourism tours and activities?	☐	☐
4. What research techniques can be used to obtain information?	☐	☐
5. What are considerations when storing information?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. Why is it important to verify information that has been collected?	☐	☐
7. Based on the process of verifying and interpreting information, further information may need to be gathered. Why?	☐	☐
8. What are examples of commercial objectives that need to be considered when developing tours and activities?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. What are examples of 'human resources' used for a tour or activity?	☐	☐
10. What are the principles for writing commentary scripts?	☐	☐
11. What are ways to involve the local community in eco-tourism tours and activities?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Why is it important to of conducting review and evaluation after a trial activity has been conducted?	☐	☐
13. What are considerations when deciding on methods to be used to promote eco-tourism tours and activities?	☐	☐
14. How can you ensure that you have updated information in regards to the eco-tourism industry?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. What are types of 'invested stakeholders' whom you may wish to share information with?	☐	☐
16. Why is it important to de-brief with staff after a trial activity has been conducted?	☐	☐
17. What activities are associated with planning an eco-tourism tour or activity?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. Why is it important to ensure any information collected in terms of planning tours or activities is accurate?	☐	☐

Written questions

Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities – D2.TTO.CL4.07

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What does the term 'eco-tourism' mean?

2. What are the key features of interpretive guiding?

3. What are sources of information to improve your understanding of eco-tourism?

4. What are methods you can use to identify the requirements of an eco-tourism tour or activity to be conducted?

5. What are examples of information you would like to identify when finding out about the needs of the customer?

6. What are examples of themes for interpretive activities?

7. What is the difference between primary and secondary data?

8. What are key activities undertaken when undertaking effective research?

9. What are the two options for storing information?

10. What activities are associated with classifying information?

11. What is the purpose of interpreting information?

12. What are the objectives of reviewing and verifying captured information?

13. What are reasons that required you to gather and learn extra information after conducting initial research?

14. What are ways to learn extra information?

15. What are key points of determining and creating activities?

16. What are examples of objectives for interpretive activities?

17. Why is it important to identify required resources for a tour or activity?

18. What are types of resources required to deliver interpretive activities?

19. What are the benefits of creating commentary scripts?

20. What are considerations when preparing commentary scripts?

21. What are tasks associated with trialling eco-tourism activities?

22. What are examples of hard copy materials that need to be prepared for a tour or activity?

23. What is the purpose of conducting a review and evaluation of a trial activity?

24. What are examples of activities that can be used to promote eco-tourism tours and activities?

25. What are areas you may wish to monitor to ensure you have updated information relating to the eco-tourism industry?

26. What are methods you can use to share general industry knowledge with stakeholders and customers?

27. What are types of revisions that can be made to how future tours and activities can be undertaken after a review of the trial activity has been completed?

28. What are types of interpretive activities that may be conducted?

29. What are examples of specialist personnel who may be useful in developing eco-tourism activities?

30. What are tasks associated with review and evaluation trial activities?

Answers to written questions

Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities – D2.TTO.CL4.07

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. What does the term 'eco-tourism' mean?

Ecotourism is a form of tourism involving visiting and understanding fragile, exotic, pristine, relatively undisturbed, or threatened natural areas.

2. What are the key features of interpretive guiding?

- Provide a verbal commentary
- Facilitate understanding
- Give local and cultural context
- Conduct appropriate and meaningful activities
- Contextualise the tour and activities.

3. What are sources of information to improve your understanding of eco-tourism?

- Relevant peak preservation and conservation bodies
- Ministries of Tourism
- Tourism Boards
- Industry Authorities
- Printed material
- The general media
- People from identified communities
- Industry personnel
- The internet.

4. What are methods you can use to identify the requirements of an eco-tourism tour or activity to be conducted?

- Reading advertising or promotional materials
- Reading the customer itinerary for the tour
- Joining the tours already developed
- Talking to other tour guides
- Obtaining a copy of the script being currently used
- Speaking with management
- Using personal knowledge of the tour route
- Reading feedback from past tour group members
- Taking other tours provided by competitors or other tour operators

- Speaking with organisational staff
 - Reading the contract for the tour
 - Talking to management.
- 5. What are examples of information you would like to identify when finding out about the needs of the customer?**
- Their needs, wants and preferences
 - Critical aspects or topics which must be covered
 - Type or nature of the information required
 - Who the people in the tour group will be.
- 6. What are examples of themes for interpretive activities?**
- Flora, including types, history, concentrations, growth patterns, threats, seasonal influences, preservation and conservation issues
 - History and heritage of the general area with attention to special items or areas of interest
 - The general natural environment
 - The built environment, including its impact on the eco-system
 - Individual species, including their history, current context and predicted future, foods, predatory inclinations, habitats, mating habits, life cycle and threats
 - Specific geographic locations and landmarks
 - Feedback from customers and co-workers suggesting topics for activities
 - Initiatives recommended by local authorities and local communities
 - Topics of general community interest.
- 7. What is the difference between primary and secondary data?**
- Primary data – collected for a specific purpose
 - Secondary data – generic information already collected.
- 8. What are key activities undertaken when undertaking effective research?**
- Ask questions
 - Make notes
 - Ensure the sources of all information are recorded
 - Read and review
 - Organise information for reference and research purposes
 - Validate the information gained
 - Obtain necessary permissions
 - Check back with the client
 - Update the research.

9. What are the two options for storing information?

- Manual filing systems
- Computerised systems

10. What activities are associated with classifying information?

- Preserving actual samples
- Organising facts into discrete sections
- Arranging information under nominated headings
- Ordering statistics in date or time sequence
- Contrasting one set of data to another set for the purposes of comparison
- Grouping similar facts and details
- Indexing the information obtained.

11. What is the purpose of interpreting information?

- Gaining further understanding of the information
- Identifying any questions you may have
- Identify the key points in which you may convey to stakeholders, colleagues or clients.

12. What are the objectives of reviewing and verifying captured information?

- Confirming the applicability and utility of material researched and provided
- Determining degree of usefulness of the information
- Confirming accuracy, currency and relevancy of information
- Validating contested pieces of information with authorities and relevant others
- Obtaining credible evidence to support the integrity of information collected
- Ensuring that no obvious sources of information have been overlooked
- Meeting with the information user to check that the material gathered is appropriate for their needs
- Checking with local communities and stakeholders to confirm or deny research material
- Determining if additional information, material or data is required to meet identified needs.

13. What are reasons that required you to gather and learn extra information after conducting initial research?

- Paint more context for the tour
- Describe additional features and information
- Answer questions asked by tour group members
- Provide extra detail emerging as required for individual parties
- Demonstrate professionalism
- Help build personal credibility
- Promote certain businesses, activities or regions associated with the tour
- Expand on information supplied as part of the scripted commentary
- Meet tour party expectations by satisfying individual need.

14. What are ways to learn extra information?

- Actively studying the material generated
- Conducting test activities
- Writing additional scripts
- Creating alternate presentation options
- Updating personal knowledge.

15. What are key points of determining and creating activities?

- Prioritising options that have been identified
- Evaluating practicality of implementing available options, including impact, cost, sensitivity, timing, safety and sustainability issues
- Planning physical and ancillary requirements to deliver selected options
- Setting specific objectives for each eco-tourism activity.

16. What are examples of objectives for interpretive activities?

- Education
- Experience
- Relaxation
- Fun
- Excitement
- Celebration of an event/historical date
- Money raising
- Recreation.

17. Why is it important to identify required resources for a tour or activity?

Identifying resources required or available is necessary for the Tour Guide to:

- Allow cross-checking of what is required against what is available to support and enable it
- Become aware of the financial parameters for the tour and each activity and thus be able to operate the tour and the activities within budget
- Make sure all required resources have been loaded before the tour departs.

18. What are types of resources required to deliver interpretive activities?

- Financial resources
- Human resources
- Materials
- On-tour documents
- Activity-related physical resources
- Presentation equipment.

19. What are the benefits of creating commentary scripts?

- They allow the quick and efficient communication of information and facts
- They can be used to reinforce and remind tour group members of detail and data pertinent to an activity
- They can be pre-planned and practiced
- They are expected
- They are inexpensive.

20. What are considerations when preparing commentary scripts?

- Identify the commentary information that needs to be conveyed
- Research the selected commentary information that needs to be conveyed
- Obtain copies of sample tour commentary scripts
- Talk to other Tour Guides
- Classify commentary information
- Develop themes for the commentary information
- Prepare draft scripts for commentary information that needs to be conveyed
- Learn supporting information
- Implement the scripted commentary.

21. What are tasks associated with trialling eco-tourism activities?

- Undertake planning of eco-tourism activities
- Conducting the eco-tourism activities as planned, including all activities and commentaries
- Including participants and observers for the trial
- Ensuring the trial reflects expected actual tour conditions for the activity
- Recording the trial for later analysis or review
- Obtaining resources
- Inspecting the condition of equipment and other items
- Obtaining handout materials, equipment and other physical resources
- Checking the activity area
- Holding a briefing.

22. What are examples of hard copy materials that need to be prepared for a tour or activity?

- Hard copy items
- Safety tips
- Information handouts
- Rules of the game
- Permanent take home copy of the commentary
- Maps
- Diagrams
- Photographs
- Sight cards
- Activity sheets
- Exercise sheets
- Question sheets
- Score cards.

23. What is the purpose of conducting a review and evaluation of a trial activity?

- Determine if the activities are effective
- Assess whether or not the activities remain relevant
- Identify satisfaction levels of tour group members
- Work out the extent to which the activities 'as delivered' in reality match expectations
- Calculate the cost of conducting the activities
- Meet quality assurance obligation
- Provide current and actual data to management
- Confirm all management protocols remain valid and effective.

24. What are examples of activities that can be used to promote eco-tourism tours and activities?

- Writing advertisements
- Designing promotional materials
- Selecting media
- Supplying media releases to the media
- Conducting media events
- Inviting agents to participate
- Providing free tours, travel and accommodation to the media
- Creating merchandise to support the tour or attraction
- Allocating resources to support the promotion
- Distributing promotional materials to targeted outlets
- Participating in a variety of shows
- Using a range of personalities to sell the message.

25. What are areas you may wish to monitor to ensure you have updated information relating to the eco-tourism industry?

- New eco-tourism developments
- New topics for discussion
- New laws and regulations relating to eco-tourism in your region
- New eco-tourism related products, services, tours and activities
- Trends and selling prices of the products and services being offered by your business and competitors
- Activities the opposition is undertaking to attract customers or to meet competition in the market place
- Changing and emerging trends
- New techniques and workplace practices
- New equipment and technology
- Initiatives relating to advertising, marketing and promotion
- Market research information.

26. What are methods you can use to share general industry knowledge with stakeholders and customers?

- One-on-one basis discussions
- Staff briefings or meetings
- E-mail
- Prepare a short handout
- Preparing posters to share the information
- Producing handouts.

27. What are types of revisions that can be made to how future tours and activities can be undertaken after a review of the trial activity has been completed?

- Altering plans
- Acquiring extra or different resources
- Acquiring extra information
- Preparing revised or new activities
- Generating revised or new commentaries
- Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities
- Changing the basic tenor of an activity
- Altering the pacing of the presentation
- Changing the scope of the activity itself
- Adjusting the duration of the activity
- Addressing the degree of engagement and participation of the tour group
- Altering the level of communication and interaction with individuals
- Taking action in relation to the administration of the activity
- Moving the location of the activity
- Responding to changing environmental and other factors
- Abandoning planned activities and initiating a substitute alternative activity
- Changing the promotional activities for the tour
- Amending staffing for the tour
- Changing parameters relating to tour customers.

28. What are types of interpretive activities that may be conducted?

- Guided site activities, including interactive and static displays
- Touring activities
- Commentaries
- Problem solving activities
- Concept testing activities
- Spotting and observation activities
- Any activity that facilitates engagement with the subject that is the focus of the activity
- Conducting role plays
- Story telling
- Games
- Demonstrations
- Interpretive walking tours

- Participant interaction
- Sensory awareness exercises
- Use of materials
- Use of technology.

29. What are examples of specialist personnel who may be useful in developing eco-tourism activities?

- Subject matter experts
- Cultural advisers
- Technical advisors and experts
- Environmental educators
- Interpretive consultants.

30. What are tasks associated with review and evaluation trial activities?

- Holding meetings
- Reviewing customer feedback
- Distributing feedback forms
- Encouraging feedback
- Interviewing stakeholders face-to-face
- Observing implementation of activities in order to record required data
- Entering data into the system for analysis
- Determining whether or not more data needs to be obtained or if current data requires clarification
- Assessing and analysing the information against the objectives set for the review process.

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities D2.TTO.CL4.07
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Research information - Prepare an eco-tourism activity - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Research information		
Describe the interpretive approach to guiding and activities	☐	☐
Identify sources of information for eco-tourism knowledge	☐	☐
Determine customer interests and potential themes for possible interpretive activities	☐	☐
Use research techniques to obtain information	☐	☐
Classify and store information	☐	☐
Verify information that has been gathered	☐	☐
Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Prepare an eco-tourism activity		
Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points for potential eco-tourism activities	☐	☐
Acquire physical resources to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points	☐	☐
Generate scripted commentaries to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points	☐	☐
Trial developed eco-tourism activities for identified concepts, themes and focal points	☐	☐
Revise developed eco-tourism activities on the basis of feedback	☐	☐
Promote prepared eco-tourism activities	☐	☐
Element 3: Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities		
Take action to receive information from relevant bodies	☐	☐
File and share new information	☐	☐
Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities	☐	☐
Create new activities	☐	☐
Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]		
Unit of competency:	Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities D2.TTO.CL4.07		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Research information			
Describe the interpretive approach to guiding and activities	☐	☐	☐
Identify sources of information for eco-tourism knowledge	☐	☐	☐
Determine customer interests and potential themes for possible interpretive activities	☐	☐	☐
Use research techniques to obtain information	☐	☐	☐
Classify and store information	☐	☐	☐
Verify information that has been gathered	☐	☐	☐
Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 2: Prepare an eco-tourism activity			
Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points for potential eco-tourism activities	☐	☐	☐
Acquire physical resources to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points	☐	☐	☐
Generate scripted commentaries to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points	☐	☐	☐
Trial developed eco-tourism activities for identified concepts, themes and focal points	☐	☐	☐
Revise developed eco-tourism activities on the basis of feedback	☐	☐	☐
Promote prepared eco-tourism activities	☐	☐	☐
Element 3: Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities			
Take action to receive information from relevant bodies	☐	☐	☐
File and share new information	☐	☐	☐
Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities	☐	☐	☐
Create new activities	☐	☐	☐
Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities	D2.TTO.CL4.07
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Research information						
Describe the interpretive approach to guiding and activities						
Identify sources of information for eco-tourism knowledge						
Determine customer interests and potential themes for possible interpretive activities						
Use research techniques to obtain information						
Classify and store information						
Verify information that has been gathered						
Learn the required information to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Prepare an eco-tourism activity						
Develop and determine concepts, themes and focal points for potential eco-tourism activities						
Acquire physical resources to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points						
Generate scripted commentaries to support identified eco-tourism concepts, themes and focal points						
Trial developed eco-tourism activities for identified concepts, themes and focal points						
Revise developed eco-tourism activities on the basis of feedback						
Promote prepared eco-tourism activities						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Update knowledge and eco-tourism activities						
Take action to receive information from relevant bodies						
File and share new information						
Incorporate new knowledge in existing activities						
Create new activities						
Correct information and activities that prove to be inaccurate or misleading						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

